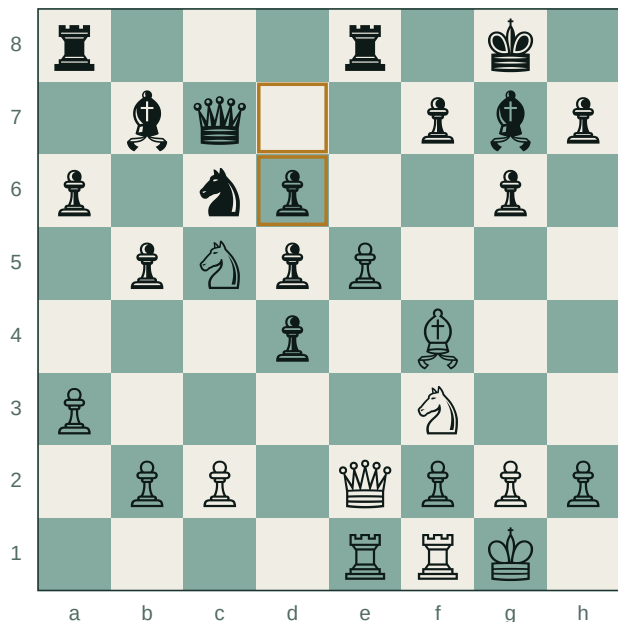


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 17

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 16...d6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. exd6 Rxe2 18. dxc7

17.exd6 The pawn captures the pawn on d6. The changed line means the queen on e2 attacks the rook on e8.
Recorded reply: **17...Rxe2**.

18.dxc7 The pawn captures the queen on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on c7. Check for tactical protection.